

**The 2026 Rural Emergency Hospital Conversion and Transformative Capital Investment Program (REH/CAP)
Awardees are:**

- Hutchinson Regional Healthcare System: \$3,000,000
 - Renovation of an idle nursing home facility on campus into an adult acute behavioral health unit and integrating with a new KU School of Medicine psychiatry residency program.
- Gove County Medical Center: \$3,000,000
 - Replacement of an unreliable mobile MRI with a permanent fixed MRI system, restoring reliable diagnostic imaging access for this 21-bed critical access hospital (CAH) in western Kansas.
- Clara Barton Medical Center: \$2,933,500
 - Construction of a sterile processing department, operating room (OR) dehumidification, and renovation of the rural health clinic to activate behavioral health space.
- Pratt Regional Medical Center: \$2,869,082
 - Conversion of two endoscopy rooms to dual-purpose OR endosuites, expanding the Family Birth Suite, and launching the first breast MRI cancer screening program.
- Freeman Fort Scott Hospital: \$2,502,999
 - Establishing the first-ever MRI services in Bourbon County, adding 8-10 healthcare jobs.
- Hays Medical Center: \$2,478,316
 - Purchase of a fixed, on-site PET scanner to replace a mobile service, serving 716 patients annually from 42 counties across western Kansas for oncology staging and cancer monitoring.
- South Central Kansas Health: \$2,378,188
 - Completion of the physical transformation of Kansas' first REH, which began converting in 2023, into a purpose-built facility, spanning behavioral health crisis capability, diagnostic and surgical retention, and outpatient conversion.
- Labette Health: \$2,145,677
 - Three-phase renovation of facility and equipment at the only Level III Trauma Center in southeast Kansas.
- PrairieStar Health Center: \$1,987,287
 - Clinical equipment to outfit 14 dental operatories in a new 14,900 sq ft dental clinic already under construction.

- Wilson Medical Center: \$1,555,143
 - Funding for a coordinated transformation including Rural Health Clinic renovation to expand primary care capacity, expanded laboratory services and emergency stabilization equipment upgrades.
- Memorial Health System: \$1,500,000
 - Modernization of the emergency department, adding a dedicated triage area, ligature-resistant behavioral health stabilization rooms, a negative pressure isolation room and a redesigned nursing station.
- Hillsboro Community Hospital: \$837,000
 - Funding to acquire a Canon Aquilion Prime 80 CT scanner with a cardiac package, expanding advanced cardiac imaging capability and reducing patient referrals to distant facilities for high-level CT in this rural south-central Kansas CAH.
- Smith County Memorial Hospital: \$550,000
 - Funding to equip and activate a second operating room, providing backup surgical capacity and ensuring continuous readiness for emergency cesarean sections.
- Greeley County Health Services: \$458,286
 - Funding to establish and sustain in-house microbiology laboratory services that will improve access to high-quality diagnostic care.
- Mercy Hospital Columbus: \$375,981
 - Installation of a fixed 3D mammography system, replacing an inadequate mobile mammography bus to provide daily, ADA-accessible breast cancer screening in southeast Kansas.
- Ashland District Hospital: \$361,478
 - Purchase of centralized patient monitoring equipment and cardiac stress testing equipment, establishing a local cardiac rehabilitation program.
- Compass Behavioral Health: \$165,000
 - Funding to acquire an FDA-cleared Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS) system, bringing advanced depression treatment to southwest Kansas.

The 2026 Regional Partnerships Grant Program (RPGP) Awardees are:

- Children's Mercy Hospital: \$6,096,062
 - Children's Mercy Hospital, in partnership with the Community Health Center of Southeast Kansas, KUMC Great Bend and Logan County Health Services, will implement the Rural Pediatric Chronic Care Network. This project will use AI-driven risk identification, Epic-integrated care coordination and telemedicine co-management to support children in rural communities with asthma, epilepsy, sleep apnea and type 1 diabetes.
- Stormont Vail Health: \$5,465,969
 - Stormont Vail HealthCare proposes PrairieLINK, a regional clinically integrated network and shared services infrastructure to strengthen rural hospital sustainability across northeastern and central Kansas through performance benchmarking, care coordination and value-based care alignment.
- Great Plains Health Alliance: \$5,000,000
 - Great Plains Health Alliance and Pioneer Health Network will deploy Avel eCare telemedicine services to 31 rural Kansas hospitals across all six Kansas Hospital Association regions, providing inpatient, emergency and psychiatric tele-coverage to stabilize rural hospital clinical and financial sustainability.
- Recovery Unlimited: \$4,290,000
 - Recovery Unlimited KS will create a technology-enabled substance use disorder treatment model linking community supervision, primary care and specialized treatment through Skyscape telehealth platform, establishing medical detox centers in south-central and western Kansas.
- Garden City Community College: \$3,439,901
 - Garden City Community College will lead the "Frontline Futures" partnership with Newman University, Colby Community College and Seward County Community College to expand clinical training, launch a diagnostic medical sonography program, develop an accelerated radiology technology pathway, and build a regional healthcare workforce pipeline across western and southwestern Kansas.
- Citizen's Foundation (Citizens Health): \$2,832,423
 - In partnership with the University of Kansas Cancer Center, Citizen's Foundation will establish a virtual tele-oncology program for nine northwestern rural Kansas counties and fund facility renovation, major diagnostic equipment (MRI, mammography, DEXA, ultrasound), and a Transforming Cancer Care clinical team.
- Special Olympics Kansas: \$2,546,981
 - Special Olympics Kansas Healthy Athletes programming will expand into an integrated healthcare delivery model, embedding screenings and care coordination into rural federally qualified health centers, hospital systems, and academic medical centers across 10 regional hubs to address severe health disparities in the intellectually and developmentally disabled population.

- Clay County Medical Center: \$2,536,000
 - Clay County Medical Center will procure and implement a da Vinci 5 robotic-assisted surgical system to bring minimally invasive surgery (general surgery, urology, gynecology), reducing the 60% of surgical patients who currently travel 20-90 miles out of county. Their primary partner is Surgical Associates, P.A., a general surgery physician group.
- Coffeyville Regional Medical Center: \$2,500,000
 - The Southeast Kansas Rural Health Workforce Expansion Partnership will create an integrated education-to-employment pipeline through expanded nursing, allied health and EMT programs at Coffeyville Community College, including enhanced simulation training capabilities.
- InterHab (StationMD): \$2,028,980
 - InterHab and StationMD will deploy 24/7 on-demand telehealth consultation services for 2,800 Kansans with intellectual and developmental disabilities in rural community and group home settings, preventing avoidable emergency department visits through real-time clinical triage and specialist access.
- Iroquois Center for Human Development: \$1,720,957
 - Iroquois Center for Human Development will lead the Kansas Frontier Behavioral Health Integration Collaborative that will build an organized healthcare arrangement integrating behavioral health into primary care, emergency medicine and outpatient settings across frontier southwest Kansas with community health workers and telehealth.
- High Plains Mental Health Center: \$1,660,879
 - High Plains Mental Health Center will deploy mobile mental health clinic vans (Be There initiative) across northwestern Kansas counties, with school liaison services and community health worker outreach through LiveWell Northwest Kansas.
- Greeley County Health Services: \$1,541,906
 - Greeley County Health Services will develop the Western Kansas Shared Services Group, a regional collaborative involving hospitals in four communities to expand specialty care (e.g., oncology), develop a shared services model, implement shared staffing and build technology infrastructure across western Kansas.
- Kansas Council on Developmental Disabilities: \$1,460,000
 - Kansas Council on Developmental Disabilities will partner with Mental Health America of South Central Kansas and two community developmental disabilities organizations to pilot implementation of the START model, an evidence-based approach to support individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities who have co-occurring mental health needs through community-based crisis prevention and intervention.
- AdventHealth Ottawa: \$1,395,814
 - AdventHealth Ottawa will establish a hub-and-spoke maternal/obstetric and specialty care delivery system with purpose-built mobile clinic units (prenatal/women's health and DEXA/bone density) and RN/APP-facilitated telehealth specialty outreach.
- Labette County Medical Center: \$1,383,289

- Labette County Medical Center and Southeast Kansas Health cooperative (three hospitals and three Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinics) will build the region's first collaborative health care governance structure, develop behavioral health crisis infrastructure, and create a behavioral health crisis stabilization unit.
- Kanza Mental Health & Guidance Center: \$1,354,975
 - Kanza Mental Health & Guidance Center will integrate the Certified Community Behavioral Health Clinic model, combining behavioral health, primary care and public health into unified whole-person care. They will also expand workforce, mobile clinic services, Medications for Addiction Treatment (MAT) access and integrated care workflows across rural northeastern Kansas counties.
- Salina Regional Health Center: \$932,310
 - Five founding providers will form AstraHealth Kansas, a shared services organization providing benchmarked clinical data, analytics dashboards and legal/governance infrastructure to rural hospitals across Kansas.
- Mercy Hospital Pittsburg: \$681,711
 - Mercy Hospital Pittsburg will implement SMART-enabled inpatient rooms with virtual specialty access (Mercy Virtual) across emergency, inpatient and step-down settings. Expands telepsychiatry, teleradiology and specialty consultation to reduce avoidable transfers.
- Kansas Health Science University: \$677,248
 - Kansas Health Science University will deploy two complementary telehealth technologies: a Drone Slit Lamp System for remote ophthalmology exams and a second diagnostic platform, in partnership with Bascom Palmer Eye Institute and Kansas College of Osteopathic Medicine.
- InterHab (CIDDH Curriculum): \$196,650
 - InterHab and IntellectAbility will deploy the Curriculum in Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities (I/DD) Healthcare — a CME/CEU-accredited eLearning program — statewide to train 300+ rural licensed clinicians in evidence-based recognition and management of chronic conditions in I/DD patients.
- Grace Team: \$173,355
 - Grace Team will deploy a regional behavioral health and dementia-capable workforce initiative across 14 rural long-term care facilities. The initiative provides two-day, on-site training and coaching visits by specialized consultants to improve skills in managing dementia-related behaviors and psychiatric symptoms. Additionally, it aims to train approximately 800 frontline staff in evidence-based behavioral health and dementia training.